

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender | Entra ID/SSO | Incident Response | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience implementing, managing and continuously improving cybersecurity across large enterprise environments. I have strong expertise in Microsoft Sentinel as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platform, using Kusto Query Language (KQL) for threat detection and hunting. I have led the deployment and optimisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender for threat monitoring, vulnerability monitoring and security posture improvement across an 8,000-user environment. My identity security experience spans Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access and Group Policy, and I have managed Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and certificate lifecycle operations. I am experienced in incident response, threat monitoring and vulnerability management, and take ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture to strengthen the organisation's overall security posture. I work closely with infrastructure operations and wider technology teams to identify vulnerabilities and respond to incidents in a timely and structured manner.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Hunting:** Microsoft Sentinel with KQL; detection rule authoring, threat hunting, alert triage and incident investigation; CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); Splunk/SPL
- **Endpoint Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)/Prevent; Tanium
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Group Policy Objects (GPO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Windows Server Infrastructure:** Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS), Domain Name System (DNS), Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP), Group Policy; Microsoft Intune; PKI/TLS certificate management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scanning, remediation tracking and executive reporting
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61-aligned IR lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK framework threat mapping; investigation, containment, eradication and post-incident review
- **Security Architecture:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, security control ownership and improvement
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR playbook development; detection engineering
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; Check Point Harmony firewall; Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS)
- **Mobile Device Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Own and manage the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR platform across the enterprise, authoring KQL-based detection rules and automated response playbooks for threat hunting, vulnerability monitoring and security posture improvement.
- Lead deployment and optimisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, providing comprehensive threat monitoring across 8,000+ users and devices.

- Manage cybersecurity controls and security architecture across the IT environment, identifying control gaps and working with infrastructure and technology teams to strengthen the organisation's overall security posture.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD, including SSO configuration, Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement and Group Policy management.
- Manage PKI/TLS certificate lifecycle, including certificate issuance, renewal and revocation across enterprise systems.
- Lead the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS and AppCheck; identify vulnerabilities, prioritise remediation and report on risk posture to senior stakeholders.
- Manage Intune MDM/MAM policies for endpoint compliance, device enrolment and mobile application management.
- Conduct and lead incident response activities including investigation, containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review, aligned to NIST SP 800-61.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account control; conduct privileged access reviews and enforce least-privilege principles.
- Work closely with infrastructure operations to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents and maintain a continuously improving security posture.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Managed Microsoft Sentinel detections and alert triage; investigated and escalated incidents, working with the infrastructure team to resolve security issues.
- Supported vulnerability monitoring using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked findings and coordinated remediation across asset owners.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD identity controls, including SSO and MFA rollout for university-wide systems.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR policies and reviewed detections to identify attacker behaviour patterns aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Supported PKI and certificate management operations, including certificate renewals and policy updates.
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM access requests, reviewed privileged sessions and maintained audit trails for compliance.
- Contributed to Group Policy management for Windows Server environments, enforcing security baselines across managed endpoints.
- Produced regular security reporting covering incidents, threats and vulnerability status for the security leadership team.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered security engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, covering endpoint protection, identity security, vulnerability assessment and network security controls.
- Managed Active Directory, DNS and DHCP infrastructure; administered Group Policy and user account provisioning.
- Implemented and maintained MFA and SSO for internal and external user access to cloud-hosted business applications.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments; produced remediation recommendations aligned to CIS Controls and ISO 27001.
- Supported Microsoft Intune MDM configuration for remote and hybrid workforce device management.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000+ users, delivering significant improvement in threat detection coverage and security posture visibility.
- Authored a comprehensive KQL-based detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false-positive alert rates by over 40% and enabling more effective threat hunting and vulnerability monitoring.

- Implemented a structured BeyondTrust PAM programme, eliminating standing privileged access and enforcing just-in-time (JIT) access management across all administrative accounts.
- Led the integration of CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM with Microsoft Sentinel, providing enriched threat intelligence and correlated detection across the enterprise.
- Designed and implemented Conditional Access policies across Entra ID and Azure AD, enforcing MFA and SSO security standards for all user populations including remote and hybrid workers.
- Reduced critical vulnerability exposure by leading a structured remediation programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, closing high-severity findings within agreed SLA timescales.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)